

Your vet bill beat inflation. Or did it?

Prices of veterinary and other pet services versus all-items inflation, January 2017 to December 2025, in 19 European countries and the United States.

+109%

vet services, Bulgaria.
Inflation was +44%.

+8%

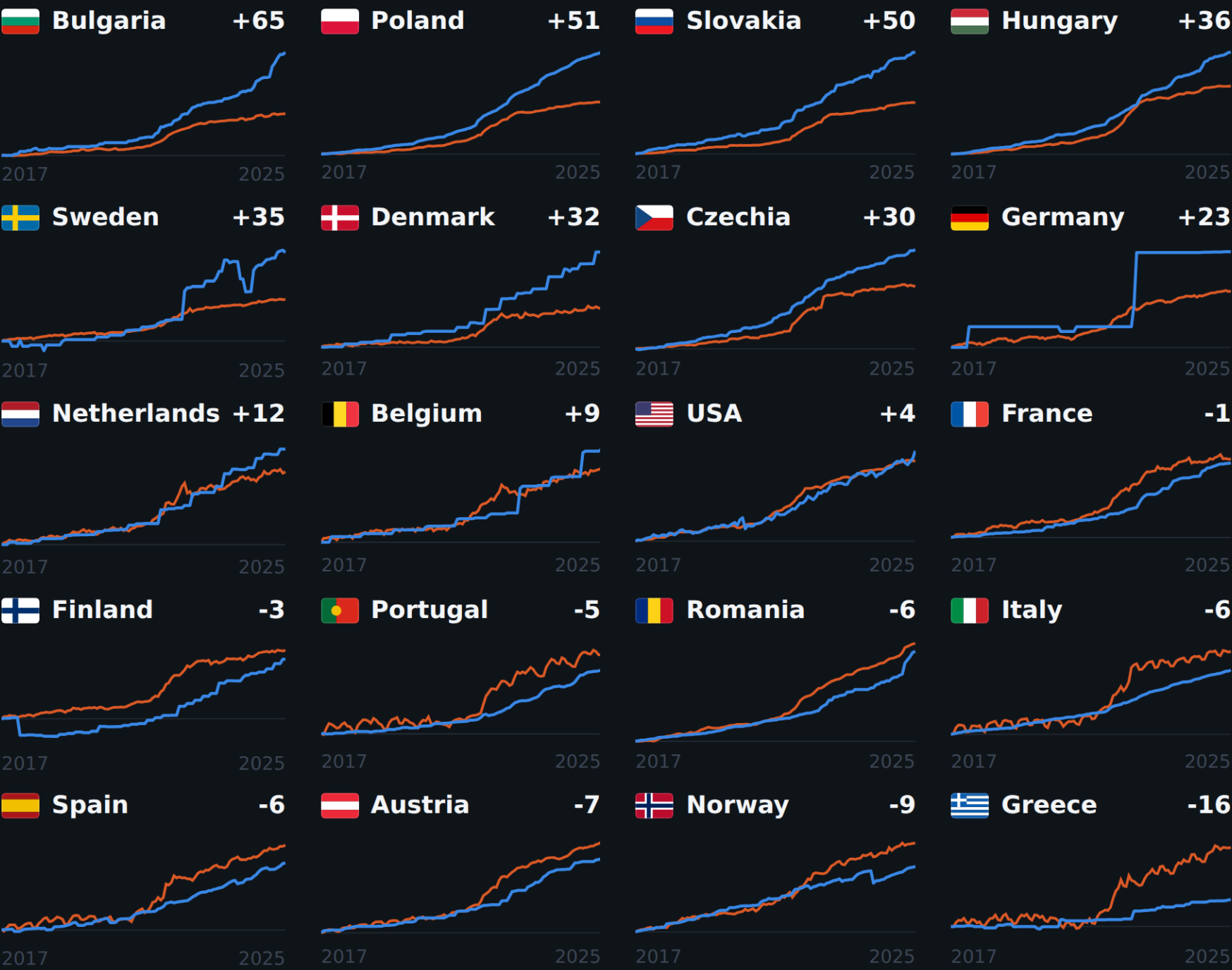
vet services, Greece.
Inflation was +24%.

Same period, same measure. In the North and East vet prices ran far ahead of inflation; across the South they fell behind it. The split is the story — slides inside.

Consumer prices — what pet owners pay. Not farm animal health costs. Sources and scope on the final slide.

Twenty markets, one window.

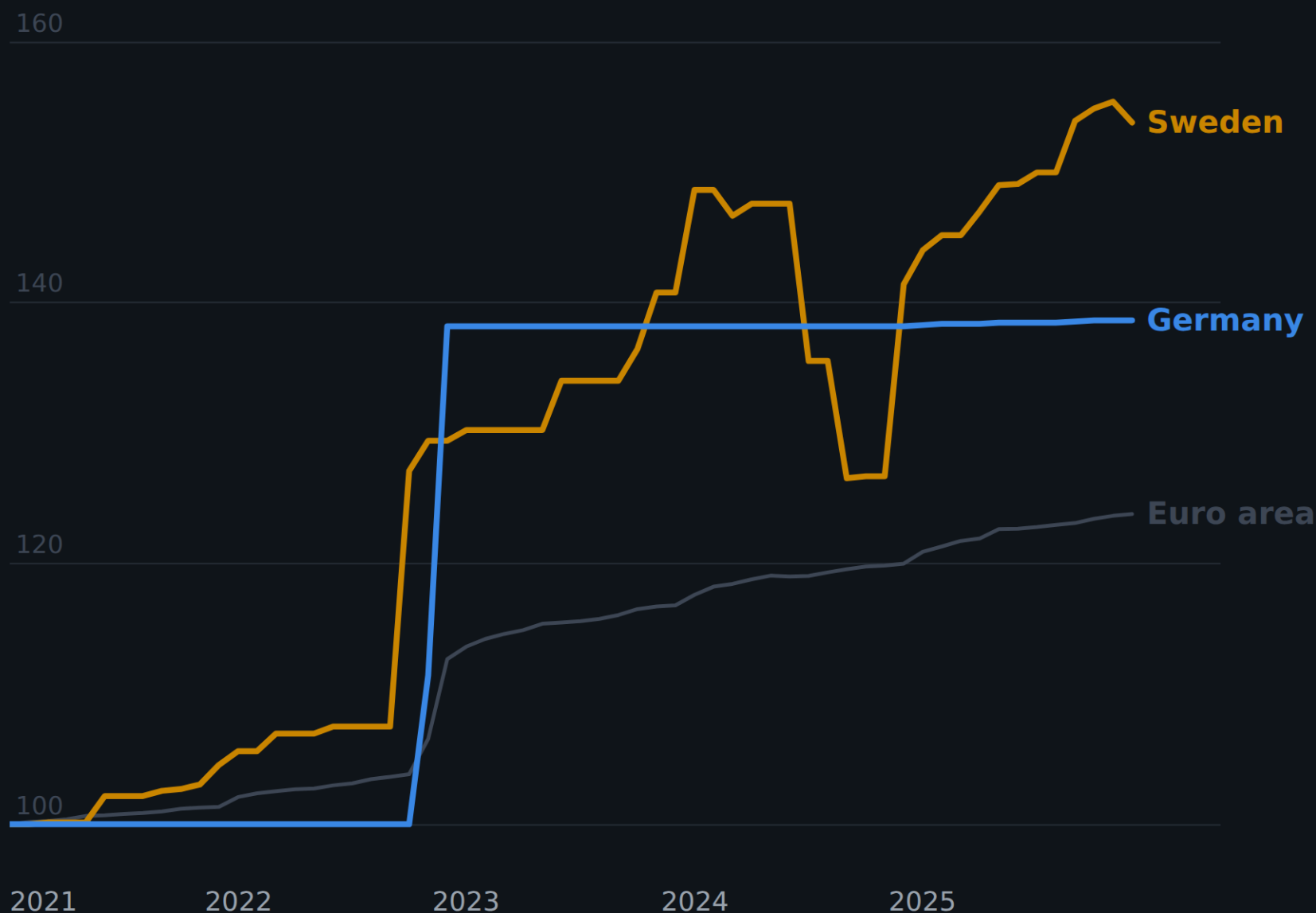
— vet prices — overall inflation
+51 = how much more vet prices rose, in points



Both lines start at 100 in Jan 2017; panels have their own scale — compare the two lines within a panel, the gap number across panels. Sorted by gap. Omitted: Türkiye (publishes no vet-services price index) and Ireland (series ends 2023).

HOW IT HAPPENED

Not a drift. Two jumps.

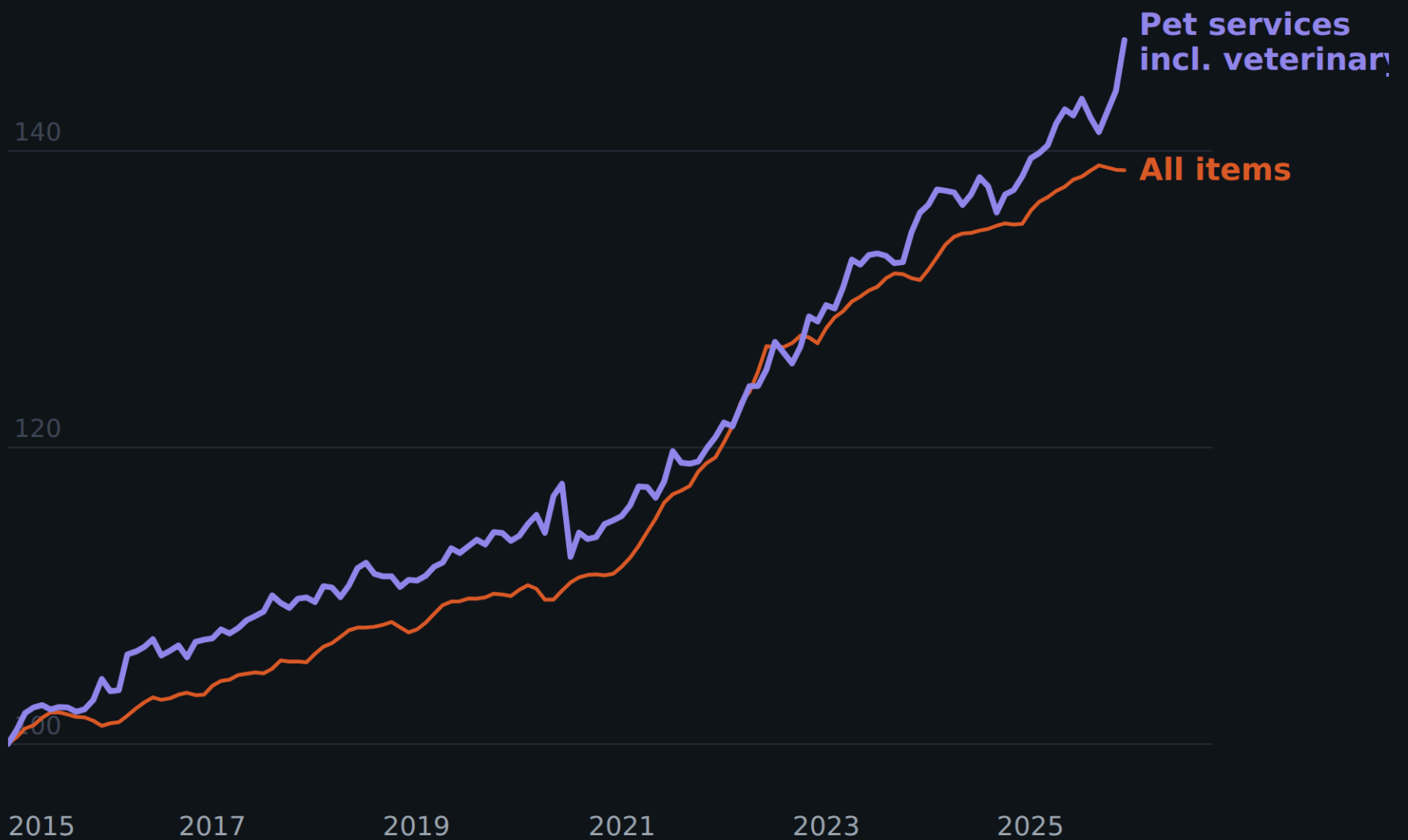


Germany: **+24% in a single month** (Dec 2022), when the national veterinary fee schedule (GOT) was revised for the first time since 1999. Sweden: **+18%** in Oct 2022, as consolidated clinic chains repriced.

Vet-services price index per market, Jan 2021 = 100, to Dec 2025. Regulated fee schedules move in steps — and reset the level for good.

THE UNITED STATES · JAN 2015 → DEC 2025

The loudest story is mid-table.



US pet services incl. veterinary: **+47%** over the decade, against +39% for all items — ahead, but no Poland. Since Jan 2021 the gap is **+4 points**: less than Denmark's, Germany's or Sweden's.

BLS CPI, US city average, not seasonally adjusted, Jan 2015 = 100. Same basket definition as the European series.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

Three readers, three moves.

Pet owners — budget by geography.

In Bulgaria, Poland, Slovakia or Sweden, index your pet budget to vet prices, not to headline inflation — the gap has compounded to 35-65 points since 2017.

Insurers & clinic operators — watch the fee schedules.

The big single moves were regulatory (Germany's GOT) or structural (Nordic chain consolidation). The next scheduled fee revision is the repricing event — not CPI drift.

Analysts — don't import the US narrative.

Vet inflation is a country story, not a global one. Greece, Italy, Spain and Austria sit below headline inflation. Check the local index before repeating the meme.

What would change this: a fee-schedule revision in a below-headline country, or a Southern-European consolidation wave, flips its lane.

WHAT THIS COVERS

Scope and sources.

MEASURE

Consumer price indices: what households pay for veterinary and other pet services, versus all-items inflation. This is not farm animal health spending.

WINDOW

Country grid: Jan 2017 → Dec 2025, the longest span all 20 markets share. Jump slide: Jan 2021 = 100. US decade slide: Jan 2015 → Dec 2025. Every slide states its own window.

EXCLUDED

Ireland — its vet-services index stops at Dec 2023. Türkiye — publishes only all-items HICP to Eurostat; a Turkish vet series would need TÜİK data.

KNOWN STEPS

Germany +24% (Dec 2022, GOT fee-schedule revision) and Sweden +18% (Oct 2022) are real repricings, not data breaks. No methodology break spans the window.

SOURCES

Eurostat prc_hicp_midx, monthly, 2015=100: CP0935 veterinary and other services for pets; CP00 all items; 1996→2025. BLS CPI via FRED, monthly, NSA: CUUR0000SS62031 pet services incl. veterinary (1997→2026); CPIAUCNS all items. Data files: data/vet-cpi-eu.json · data/vet-cpi-us.json, cut 11 Aug 2026 — every figure recomputable from them.

Personal analysis of public statistics. Views my own.